



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 15

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Hand Tool Safety: Chisels, Gouges & Planes

OVERVIEW:

Sharp hand tools cause more lacerations per hour of use than almost any power tool, primarily because they are used without the same level of attention. A sharp chisel can cut to the bone in a fraction of a second. Sharp hand tools are essential for quality work — but they require discipline in how they are

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. The most important rule with any sharp hand tool is to cut away from your body at all times. This sounds obvious, but in practice, operators frequently pull a chisel or plane blade toward themselves for control or convenience. If the chisel slips, the blade travels directly into your hand, forearm, or torso. Reposition the workpiece so you can always push the cutting edge away from
2. Sharp tools are significantly safer than dull ones. A dull chisel or plane blade requires much more force to cut, and that extra force means the tool can slip suddenly and travel a much greater distance when it does. Keep your chisels sharp with regular honing and occasional full sharpening on a bench stone. A properly sharp chisel pares wood with light pressure and stops where you intend
3. Use the right striking tool for the job. Wood chisels are designed to be driven with a wooden or rubber mallet — not a steel hammer. A steel hammer concentrates impact on a small area of the chisel handle and can crack or shatter it over time, which can then cause the chisel to become a projectile. If you are using a steel hammer to drive a chisel, you are using the wrong tool.
4. Chisel storage requires as much thought as chisel use. A loose chisel in a toolbox drawer bounces against other tools and dulls quickly. More importantly, a chisel rolling around in a box can cut the hand reaching into it. Store chisels in a roll, a blade guard, or a dedicated rack. Never place a chisel unguarded on a work surface where it can roll off or be grabbed by someone who does not

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: How do you check if a chisel is sharp enough for safe use?
Q2: How are our chisels and sharp hand tools currently stored on this job?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Always cut away from your body and all bystanders every time
- Keep tools sharp — dull tools require more force and slip more often
- Use a mallet, not a hammer, to drive wood chisels
- Never carry a chisel in your pocket — use a tool roll for transport
- Clamp the workpiece; never hold it in your hand while chiseling

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 15

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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